

Lingo — Selling & Marketing Content

The single reference for what Lingo is, why people buy it, the plans, and the exact content the marketing website should carry. Grounded in the shipped product.

Where a selling point depends on a feature that isn't fully built yet, it's tagged ⚠️

BUILD-FIRST — do not publish that claim until the feature ships (see §12).

Prices/features are the single source of truth in `src/site.js`.

1. How to use this doc

- **§2–§7** are the *strategy* — positioning, audiences, selling points, competitors, objections, plans.
 - **§8** is the *build spec* — page-by-page content the site must carry (fill the Astro pages from it).
 - **§9–§11** are the *raw material* — proof/assets to gather, a headline/CTA bank, and SEO targets.
 - **§12** is the *truth gate* — claims to verify or build before they go live (this protects the brand).
-

2. Positioning

Name: Lingo · **Tagline (current):** *Multilingual WordPress, without the bloat.*

One-liner: Lingo makes any WordPress site multilingual — per-field translation, clean URLs, and SEO-ready hreflang — without duplicating your posts or bolting on a heavy translation suite.

Elevator pitch (30s):

Going multilingual on WordPress usually means WPML: a heavy plugin that clones every post per language, slows your site, and locks you in. Lingo takes a different approach — it keeps **one canonical post** and stores each language in a compact side table. Your post lists stay clean, your URLs stay tidy (`/fr/...`), hreflang is

automatic, and you translate right inside the block editor. Already on WPML, Polylang, qTranslate or TranslatePress? Lingo migrates you in **one command**, with a free preview and a full undo. Free for one extra language; Pro for unlimited.

The enemy (what we position against): bloat, post-duplication, lock-in, and slow multilingual sites.

The promise: *A fast, clean, standalone multilingual layer you can trust with your content — and switch to without risk.*

Brand voice: confident, technical-but-plain, calm. We don't hype; we show. Developer-credible, non-salesy. Orange accent ([#e8730c](#)), system fonts, fast pages (the site itself is the proof).

3. Who we're selling to (personas)

Persona	What they care about	The hook for them
WordPress developer / freelancer	Clean data model, no bloat, WP-CLI, hooks, predictable behavior	"One canonical post + a side table. No duplicated posts. Migrate in one command."
Agency	Repeatable across client sites, unlimited sites, fast handoffs, support	Agency/Lifetime plan · migration + undo · "unlimited sites"
Site owner / marketer escaping WPML	Speed, SEO, cost, getting <i>off</i> WPML safely	vs-WPML page · free dry-run + undo · lighter & faster
WooCommerce store owner	Translated products, prices/URLs under a language	WooCommerce product translation + <code>/fr/shop</code>
Multisite/network builder	Consistency, licensing that scales	Agency tier · self-hosted updates

Primary target for launch: **developers and agencies switching off WPML** (highest intent, clearest pain).

4. Core selling points

4.1 The headline differentiators (lead with these)

1. **One canonical post, not duplicates.** Lingo stores translations in a compact side table keyed by field + language. Your post lists, IDs and admin stay clean — no per-language clones multiplying your database. (*This is the #1 wedge against WPML/Polylang.*)
2. **Fast by design.** A lightweight layer of native WordPress hooks, not a translation-management suite. The marketing site itself is static and sub-second — proof of the philosophy. (*See §12 on how to phrase speed claims honestly.*)
3. **Switch without risk.** Free migration **dry-run** shows exactly what will change; **apply** with one command; **full undo** if you change your mind. Import from **WPML, Polylang, qTranslate-Xt and TranslatePress.**
4. **Standalone — no WPML, no lock-in.** Lingo has its own storage and its own APIs. Self-hosted, FOSS-friendly, no third-party SaaS in the request path.
5. **SEO done right.** Automatic **hreflang** + **x-default**, clean `/{{code}}/` URLs, per-language `<title>/meta`, and integration with Yoast/RankMath/SEOPress titles.

4.2 Feature selling points (the "what you get")

- **Per-field translation** — post title, content, excerpt, custom fields (ACF/meta), taxonomy terms & descriptions, media alt text/captions. Translate exactly what needs translating.
- **Translate in the block editor** — a **"Language (Lingo)" panel** switches the editing language per post, with a *Copy from default* starting point. Your source-language content is never overwritten.
- **Native Gutenberg block translation** — core blocks translate as normal `post_content`, rendered through WordPress's own block pipeline.
- **A switcher you can place anywhere** — a `[lingo_switcher]` **shortcode**, a **widget**, a **"Language Switcher" block**, **Appearance → Menus** language items, or the `lingo_language_switcher()` template tag. List, inline or dropdown styles.
- **Clean URL routing** — default language at the root, every other under `/{{code}}/`. Slugs translatable per language.

- **WooCommerce compatible** — translated product titles, descriptions, categories, variation attribute values; cart/checkout/account under per-language URLs.
- **String translation** — theme/plugin interface text via a simple registry (a `pll__`/`icl__` compat shim keeps migrated themes working).
- **Developer-friendly** — WP-CLI commands, REST language resolution, a documented hook/filter API, trilingual docs.
- **Self-hosted Pro updates** — updates flow through WordPress's normal update screen, integrity-checked (sha256 + signature), from your own store — no separate update dashboard.

4.3 Outcome-based selling points (the "so what")

- *Keep your site fast* even in five languages.
- *Keep your SEO* — one canonical URL structure, correct alternates, no duplicate-content mess.
- *Keep your sanity* — no duplicated posts to maintain; edit one post, translate its fields.
- *Keep your options* — migrate in, and (if you must) migrate out; it's your data.

5. Competitive positioning

Primary comparison: WPML (that's who people are leaving). Keep it factual and fair — the site's `vs-wpml` page already hedges subjective rows; keep that discipline (avoid hard false claims).

Dimension	Lingo	WPML	Polylang	TranslatePress
Content model	One post + side table	Duplicate post per language	Duplicate post per language	Dynamic string-level
Post lists / IDs	Stay stable	Multiply	Multiply	Stable
Weight / speed	Lightweight, native hooks	Heavy suite	Lighter than WPML	Front-end translation layer

Dimension	Lingo	WPML	Polylang	TranslatePress
Clean URLs + hreflang	✓ built in	✓	✓	✓
Migrate in	✓ WPML/Polylang/qTranslate/TP, dry-run + undo	—	Import tools vary	—
Editor UX	In-editor language panel	Advanced Translation Editor (separate)	Separate post per language	Front-end visual editor
WooCommerce	✓ (built in)	✓ (separate add-on)	✓ (add- on)	✓ (add-on)
Pricing	Free core + Pro from \$69/yr (+ lifetime)	Annual tiers	Free + Pro	Free + Pro
Lock-in	Low (standalone, your data)	Medium	Low– med	Low–med

The honest framing: "WPML is powerful and mature; if you want the heaviest translation-management suite, it's there. If you want a **fast, clean, standalone** multilingual layer — and a safe way to *leave* WPML — that's Lingo." Never claim Lingo does *more* than WPML; claim it does the **core job lighter, cleaner, and without lock-in**.

6. Objection handling (put these into the FAQ)

- **"Do I need WPML or Polylang?"** No — Lingo is standalone with its own storage. It can *import* from them, but doesn't depend on any of them at runtime.
- **"Will it duplicate my posts?"** No. One canonical post; translations live in a separate table, so post lists and IDs stay stable.
- **"How risky is switching?"** Low — preview the whole migration for free, apply with one command, undo any time. Your original content is never destroyed.

- **"Is my SEO safe?"** Yes — automatic hreflang + x-default, clean per-language URLs, per-language titles/meta, and integration with the major SEO plugins.
 - **"What about WooCommerce?"** Supported — product content, categories, variation attributes, and cart/checkout/account under per-language URLs.
 - **"What's free vs Pro?"** Free covers one secondary language and all core translation. Pro adds unlimited languages, one-command migration apply, and priority support + auto-updates.
 - **"Can I get a refund?"** Yes — 14-day money-back guarantee.
 - **"Is it locked to a SaaS?"** No — self-hosted, no third-party service in the request path; it's your data.
-

7. Plans & pricing

Source of truth: `src/site.js` (`TIERS`, `LIFETIME`, `FREE_FEATURES`, `PRO_FEATURES`). Current values:

Free (WordPress.org)

- **One secondary language** + all core translation
- Per-field translation (title, content, fields, taxonomies, media)
- Clean URLs + hreflang + language switcher
- Free migration **dry-run + undo**
- *Positioning*: the honest on-ramp. "Try the whole engine on one extra language, free."

Pro (annual)

Plan	Sites	Price/yr	Best for
Single Site	1 site	\$69	Solo site owner
Business 🌟 (featured)	5 sites	\$129	Small studio / few sites
Agency	Unlimited sites	\$199	Agencies & freelancers

Lifetime

- **\$399, unlimited sites, pay once** — the capped founder's deal at launch (scarcity: "limited").

What every Pro plan adds

- Unlimited languages
- One-command migration from WPML, Polylang, qTranslate & TranslatePress (apply, not just preview)
- WooCommerce product translation
- Machine-translation assistance ⚠️ **BUILD-FIRST** (see §12)
- Editorial workflow tools ⚠️ **BUILD-FIRST / verify scope** (see §12)
- Priority support + auto-updates

Pricing psychology to use on the site:

- Anchor with **Business as "featured/most popular"** (middle option, best value-per-site).
- Show **annual** clearly; the **Lifetime** card framed as "pay once, limited."
- Every plan: **14-day money-back guarantee** badge + "Free version available" link (honesty + de-risk).
- Emphasize **per-site value** for Agency ("unlimited sites") — the agency math sells itself.

8. The marketing website — page-by-page content spec

Existing pages: / (home), /features/, /pricing/, /vs-wpml/, /privacy/, /terms/, /refund/. Add: /migrate/ (or a strong homepage section), /about/ or /contact/, and later /blog/ + /changelog/. Every page: canonical, OG/Twitter meta, JSON-LD where relevant, and one clear primary CTA.

8.1 Homepage /

Sections, in order:

1. **Hero** — headline + subhead + primary CTA ("Get Pro") + secondary ("Read the docs"). Headline candidates in §10. Include the real one-command migration code sample (already fixed to `wp lingo wpml-dryrun / wpml-migrate`).
2. **Social proof strip** — stat tiles ("4 plugins you can migrate from", languages, etc.).
⚠️ Replace self-authored stats with **real** numbers/logos/testimonials as they exist (§12).
3. **The 3–4 core differentiators** (from §4.1) as feature cards with icons.
4. **"Translate in the block editor"** — a short visual: the Language panel + per-field translation. (*Needs a screenshot/GIF — §9.*)
5. **Migrate off WPML in one command** — the migration promise (preview → apply → undo), 4 source logos, code sample, link to `/migrate/` or the docs migration guide.
6. **WooCommerce** — one row: translated products + `/fr/shop|cart|checkout`.
7. **Pricing teaser** — 3 tiers + lifetime, link to `/pricing/`.
8. **FAQ** (from §6).
9. **Final CTA** — "Install the free version, or go Pro."
10. **Footer** — Product / Resources / Legal columns (already built), + WordPress.org link.

8.2 Features `/features/`

- Group features by theme: **Translation, URLs & SEO, Editor UX, WooCommerce, Developer, Migration, Licensing & updates.**
- Each: a plain-language benefit line + the concrete capability (from §4.2). Screenshots where possible.
- End with a pricing CTA.

8.3 Pricing `/pricing/`

- 3 annual tiers + 1 lifetime card (Business featured). Per §7.
- **FAQ** specific to buying: refund, sites/activations, renewals, free vs Pro, upgrade later.
- Trust: 14-day guarantee, "secure checkout," free-version link.
- Buy buttons hand off to checkout (`buyUrl`) — MoR at launch.

8.4 vs WPML `/vs-wpml/`

- The comparison table (\$5), with the honesty disclaimer kept.
- A short "why we built it differently" narrative (one canonical post).
- CTA: "Migrate off WPML — free preview + undo."

8.5 Migrate **/migrate/** (new, high-intent — build this)

- Headline: "Move to Lingo without losing your translations."
- The 3-step promise: **Preview (free) → Apply (one command) → Undo (any time)**.
- Per-source blurbs: WPML, Polylang, qTranslate-Xt, TranslatePress — what gets imported.
- The real CLI commands + a link to each docs migration guide.
- Reassurance: "Your original content is never destroyed."

8.6 About / Contact

- Who's behind it (builds trust for a paid plugin), support email, response expectation, docs link.
- Optional: the "why" story (WPML fatigue → build something lighter).

8.7 Legal (already built)

- **/privacy/**, **/terms/**, **/refund/** — keep; have counsel review before launch (LEGAL placeholders).

8.8 Later: Blog **/blog/** + Changelog **/changelog/**

- Blog for SEO ("how to make WordPress multilingual", "migrate from WPML", "WooCommerce multilingual").
 - Changelog (generate from **readme.txt**) — signals active maintenance, aids trust + SEO.
-

9. Proof & assets to gather (conversion depends on these)

- **Product screenshots / short GIFs:** Settings → Lingo; the block-editor Language panel; the switcher (list/dropdown); a [/fr/](#) front-end; the migration dry-run output; WooCommerce [/fr/shop](#).
 - **A 60–90s demo video:** "Add a language → translate a page → see [/fr/](#) live → migrate off WPML."
 - **Testimonials / logos:** collect 3–5 real quotes at/after launch (beta users, early buyers). Until then, **do not fabricate** — use a stats strip or "as seen on WordPress.org" instead.
 - **Trust badges:** 14-day guarantee, secure checkout (MoR), "GPL / open-source," WordPress.org rating once it exists.
 - **OG/Twitter image:** a branded 1200×630 card (the site declares [summary_large_image](#) — ship the asset).
 - **wp.org assets:** banner, icon, screenshots (also reused on the site).
-

10. Messaging bank (headlines, subheads, CTAs, microcopy)

Hero headline candidates:

- "Multilingual WordPress, without the bloat."
- "Go multilingual — keep your site fast."
- "One post. Every language. No duplicates."
- "The lightweight way to make WordPress multilingual."

Subheads:

- "Per-field translation, clean URLs and automatic hreflang — on one canonical post, not a copy per language."
- "Migrate off WPML in one command. Free preview, full undo."

Section headlines:

- "No duplicated posts. Ever."

- "Translate right in the block editor."
- "Switch off WPML without the fear."
- "Fast pages, in every language."
- "Your data. Your site. No lock-in."

Primary CTAs: "Get Pro" · "Start free" · "Get the free version" · "See pricing" **Secondary CTAs:** "Read the docs" · "Compare with WPML" · "See how migration works"

Microcopy: "14-day money-back guarantee." · "Free version on WordPress.org." · "No WPML required." · "Self-hosted. Your data." · "Cancel anytime."

11. SEO

Primary keywords / intents:

- "wordpress multilingual plugin", "wpml alternative", "migrate from wpml", "translate wordpress without wpml", "polylang alternative", "woocommerce multilingual", "wordpress hreflang plugin", "gutenberg translate blocks".
- High-intent long-tail for the blog: "how to migrate from WPML to [x]", "make WooCommerce multilingual", "WordPress multilingual without duplicating posts".

On-page: unique **<title>** + meta description per page (Base layout already supports it); canonical; **hreflang** on the marketing site itself if it's ever localized. **Structured data:** SoftwareApplication

- AggregateOffer (already added), and FAQPage JSON-LD on pages with FAQs.
- Sitemap + robots** (added).
-

12. Truthfulness gate — verify or build BEFORE publishing these claims

This protects the brand (and keeps wp.org/MoR review clean). Do not ship a claim until its feature is real.

Claim on the site	Status today	Action before it goes live
"Machine-translation assistance" (Pro feature)	Seam only — no bundled provider/UI (PL-06)	Build the DeepL/Google provider + a "Translate" button, or relabel as "Machine-translation ready (bring your provider)" / mark Roadmap
"Editorial workflow tools" (Pro feature)	Capability gate exists; scope thin	Verify what actually ships; describe only what's real, or mark Roadmap
Testimonials / customer logos	None real yet	Collect real ones; never fabricate
"<1s / blazing-fast page load" style claims	Unverified	Measure (Lighthouse) and cite, or soften to "static, sub-second by design" without a hard number
WordPress.org rating/stars, install count	Not published yet	Add only after the plugin is live on wp.org
Screenshots/demo	Not captured	Capture from the real plugin (don't mock)
Prices / plan sizes	✅ Real (site.js)	Keep site.js the single source of truth
Migration (WPML/Polylang/qTranslate/TP, dry-run + undo)	✅ Built + tested	Safe to sell
WooCommerce product translation	✅ Built + e2e-verified	Safe to sell
Switcher (shortcode/widget/block/menu)	✅ Built + live-verified	Safe to sell
In-editor language panel	✅ Built + live-verified	Safe to sell
hreflang / clean URLs / per-field translation	✅ Built	Safe to sell

Rule of thumb: every claim on the site should map to a shipped feature (a demo, a docs page, or a test). This is the same discipline that caught the "switcher shortcode that didn't exist" earlier — apply it to marketing copy too.

13. Launch content checklist

- ☐ Real domains swapped in `site.js` (store, docs, wporg) + `CHECKOUT.mode = 'mor'` with tier URLs
 - ☐ OG image shipped; robots/sitemap present (done); FAQPage JSON-LD on FAQ pages
 - ☐ Screenshots + demo video captured from the real plugin
 - ☐ MT + workflow claims resolved (built or relabeled) per §12
 - ☐ Legal pages reviewed by counsel; `LEGAL.company` set
 - ☐ `/migrate/` page built; homepage migration section wired to docs
 - ☐ At least 3 real testimonials or an honest "new & open-source" trust framing
 - ☐ Pricing verified against the live store/MoR SKUs
 - ☐ Every headline claim mapped to a shipped feature (§12)
-

Keep this doc and `src/site.js` in sync. When a BUILD-FIRST item ships, move it out of §12 and into the live selling points. See also: the product truth in `~/Sites/DHChen/docs/lingo-excellence-plan-2026.md`.